

Recruiting Handbook

The friendly guide to hiring with Nextcloud — from the first application in your inbox to the signed offer. Written for HR teams and hiring managers; no technical knowledge needed.



For Recruiting 0.7 · August 2026 · Everything in this handbook stays on your own server.

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01 Recruiting in five minutes

Recruiting manages your whole hiring funnel inside Nextcloud. Applications become cards on a board, your team votes on them without influencing each other, interviews book themselves against real calendars, and offers need a second pair of eyes before they go out.

The pipeline

Every candidate moves through the same four active stages — **New → Screening → Interview → Offer** — and ends in exactly one of three final states: **Hired**, **Rejected** or **Withdrawn**. Each stage has its own color, used everywhere in the app: board columns, table chips and report charts. Once you know that Screening is amber and Offer is green, you can read any screen at a glance.

Who sees what

There is no separate user management. You work with the Nextcloud accounts your colleagues already have, in one of four roles:

Role	Who	What they can do and see
Recruiter	Members of the HR group (your admin configures which group)	Everything: all openings, all candidates, templates, the triage inbox, the talent pool, reports, GDPR actions
Hiring manager	Picked per opening	Runs the process for their opening: sees all its candidates, moves stages, assigns screeners, books interviews, creates offers, sends mail
Interviewer / screener	Picked per opening or per candidate	Sees *only the candidates assigned to them*. Reads the profile and documents, votes, joins the discussion. **Never** sees salary or offer data
Observer	Picked per opening	May watch the pipeline and reports of that opening, but not act

🔒 A Nextcloud *administrator* has no candidate access at all — being admin only allows configuring the mailbox and retention settings. Candidate documents never appear in anyone's Files app; they live in protected app storage.

The golden rules

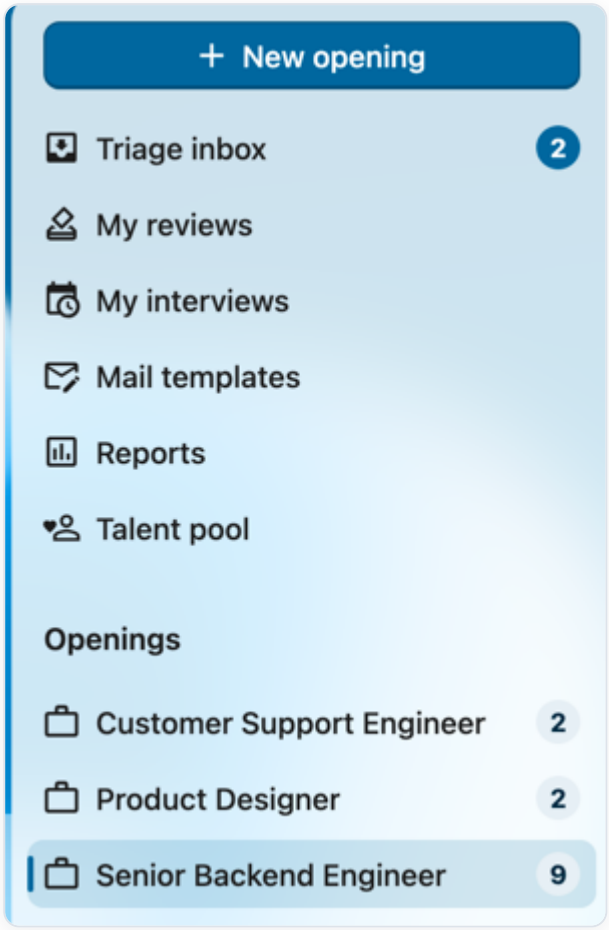
- **Nothing goes out unreviewed.** Every mail to a candidate shows you a preview first — you can edit every word before it is sent.
- **Every action is logged.** Stage moves, votes, mails, offers — the candidate's Log tab is the complete history.
- **Votes are blind.** You cannot see your colleagues' votes until you have cast your own.
- **Offers need four eyes.** You can never approve your own offer.

02 Finding your way around

One left sidebar, one board. That's the whole app.

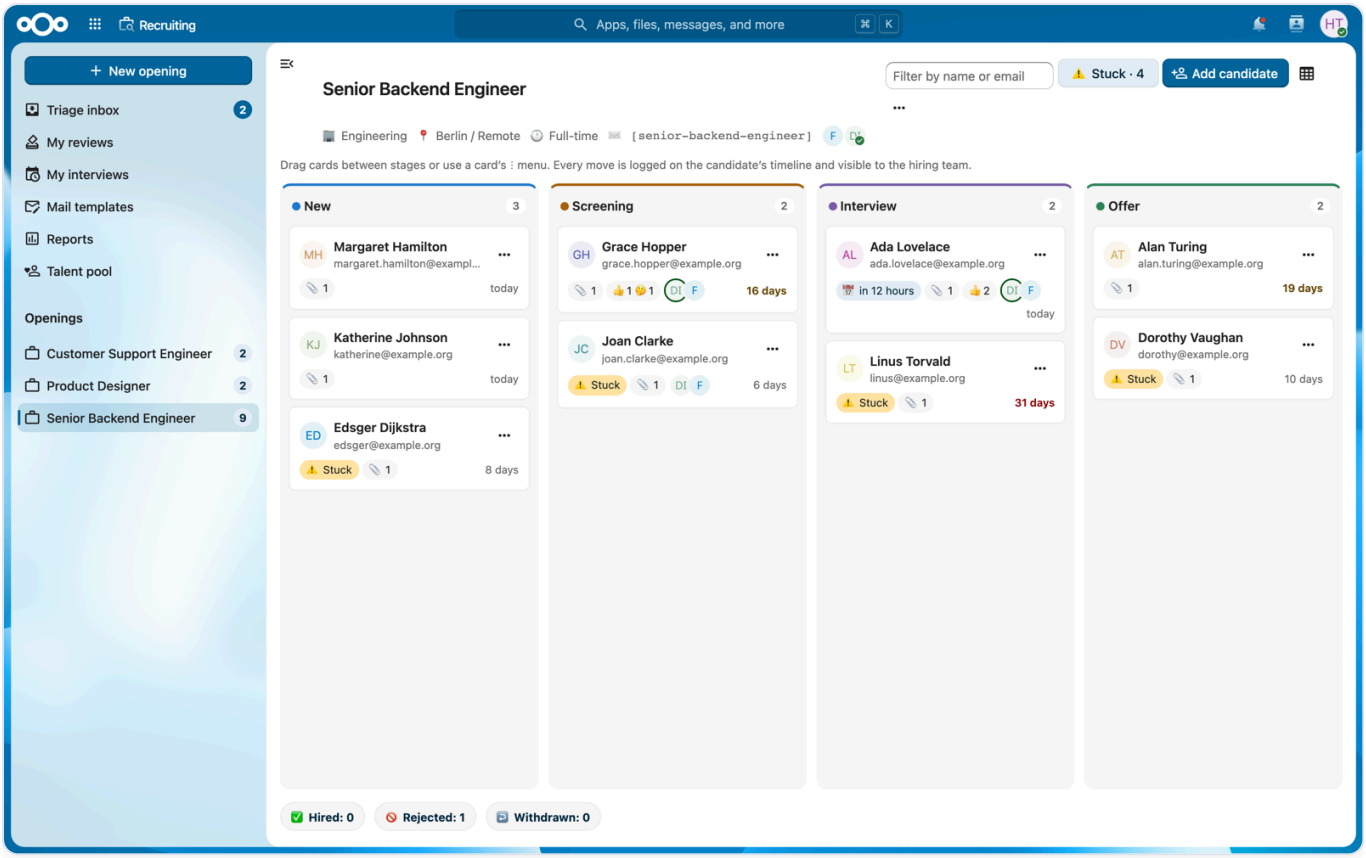
The navigation

- **New opening** — create a job opening (recruiters).
- **Triage inbox** — applications that arrived by mail without a matching opening. The badge counts what's waiting.
- **My reviews** — candidates *you* still owe a vote.
- **My interviews** — interviews where you are on the panel.
- **Mail templates** — the texts used for invitations, rejections, offers and confirmations.
- **Reports** — live numbers over your openings.
- **Talent pool** — candidates who agreed to be considered for future openings.
- **Openings** — one entry per job, with the number of active candidates. Closed openings collapse at the bottom.
- **Handbook** — this document, always one click away.

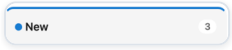


The navigation: your personal to-do lists sit at the top, the openings below.

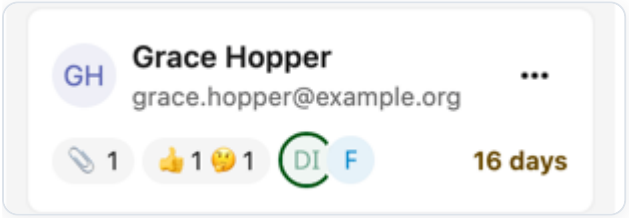
The board



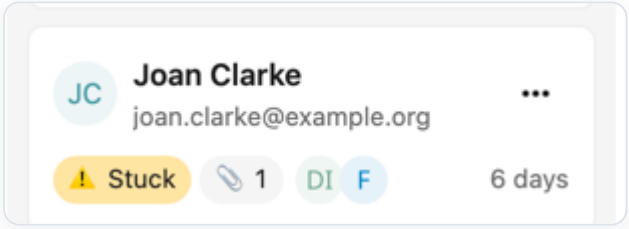
The pipeline board of one opening. Every column is a stage; every card a candidate.

Move a candidate by **dragging the card** to another column, or use the card's ⋮ **menu** if you prefer clicks (it works fully with the keyboard, too). Every move is logged and visible to the hiring team. The column header  always shows the *true* total — if a stage holds more than 100 candidates, the column loads them in pages with a *Show more* button.

Anatomy of a card



Attachments · votes (👍 1 🤔 1) · the screeners (a **green ring** means this person has voted — never *what* they voted) · time in this stage.



The ⚠ **Stuck** chip: something needs your attention here. Hover it to see why.

The time-in-stage indicator changes color as candidates wait: **amber after two weeks**, **red after a month**. Nobody should be forgotten in a column.

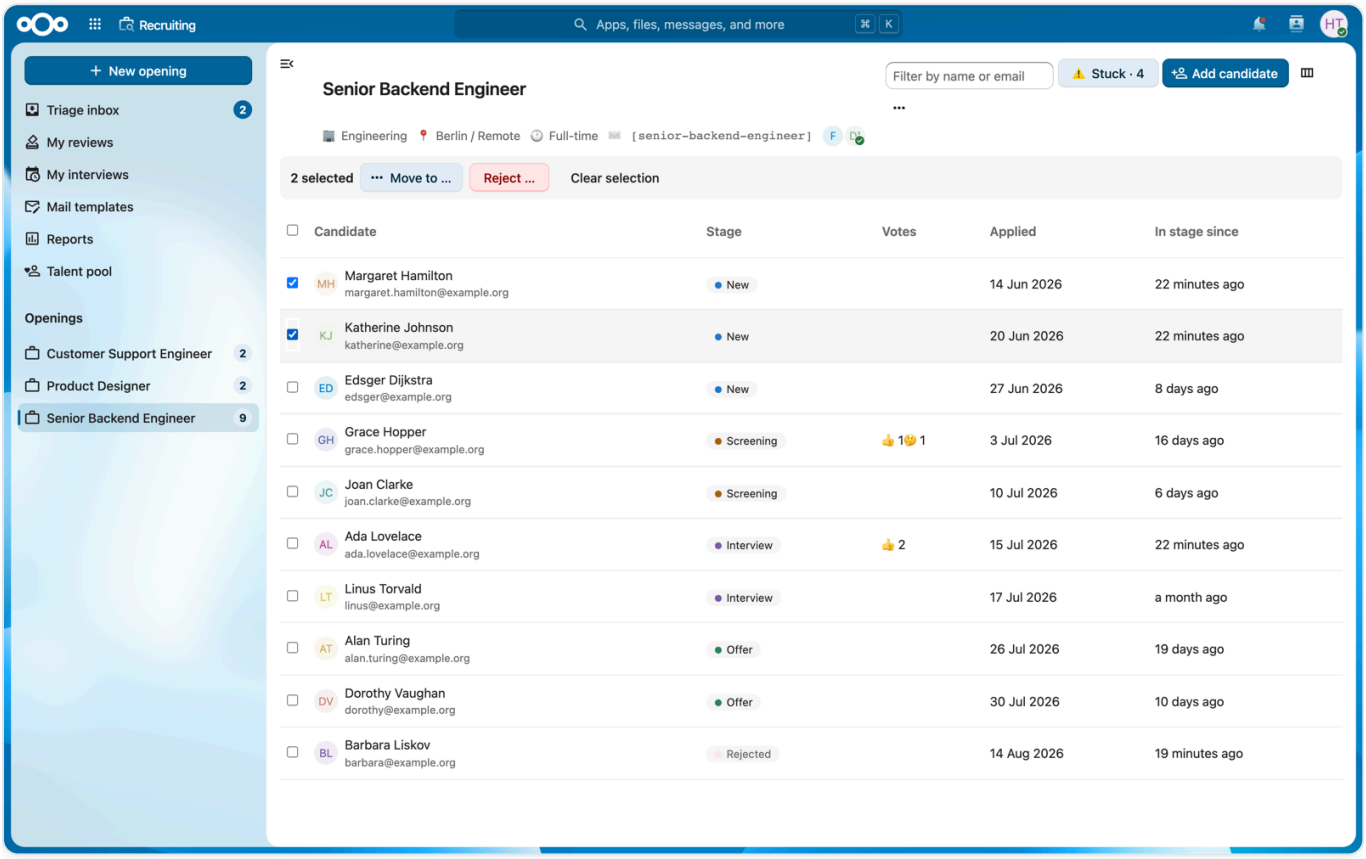
The toolbar

 narrows the board to matching names or email addresses.  shows only candidates where something is stuck (more in chapter 9).  adds a candidate manually — with drag-and-drop CV upload.

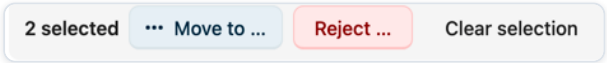
Below the board, three chips summarize the finished candidates — 

— click one to show those candidates as an extra column (and in the table view); click it again, or the column's arrow, to fold them away. They are only loaded when you open them, so the board stays fast on long-running openings.

The table view



The same candidates as a sortable table — finished ones appear once their chip is opened.

Click any column header to sort (a third click restores the original order). Managers get checkboxes: select several candidates and the bulk bar appears — 

— to move them together or reject them in one go. The bulk rejection asks for one reason and one mail text; the placeholders (such as the name) are filled in for each candidate, and you see the finished mail for the first one before anything is sent. Afterwards a summary lists who was rejected and who could not be (for example because their mail could not be sent).

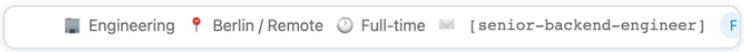
03 How applications arrive

Most applications should reach the board without anyone lifting a finger. That's the zero-touch intake.

By email — the normal way

Your admin connects a dedicated application mailbox (for example `jobs@your-company.com`). The app checks it every five minutes. Every new mail becomes a candidate: name and address are read from the sender, the mail text lands on the candidate's timeline, and attachments become documents.

Every opening has a **mail tag**, shown in its header:



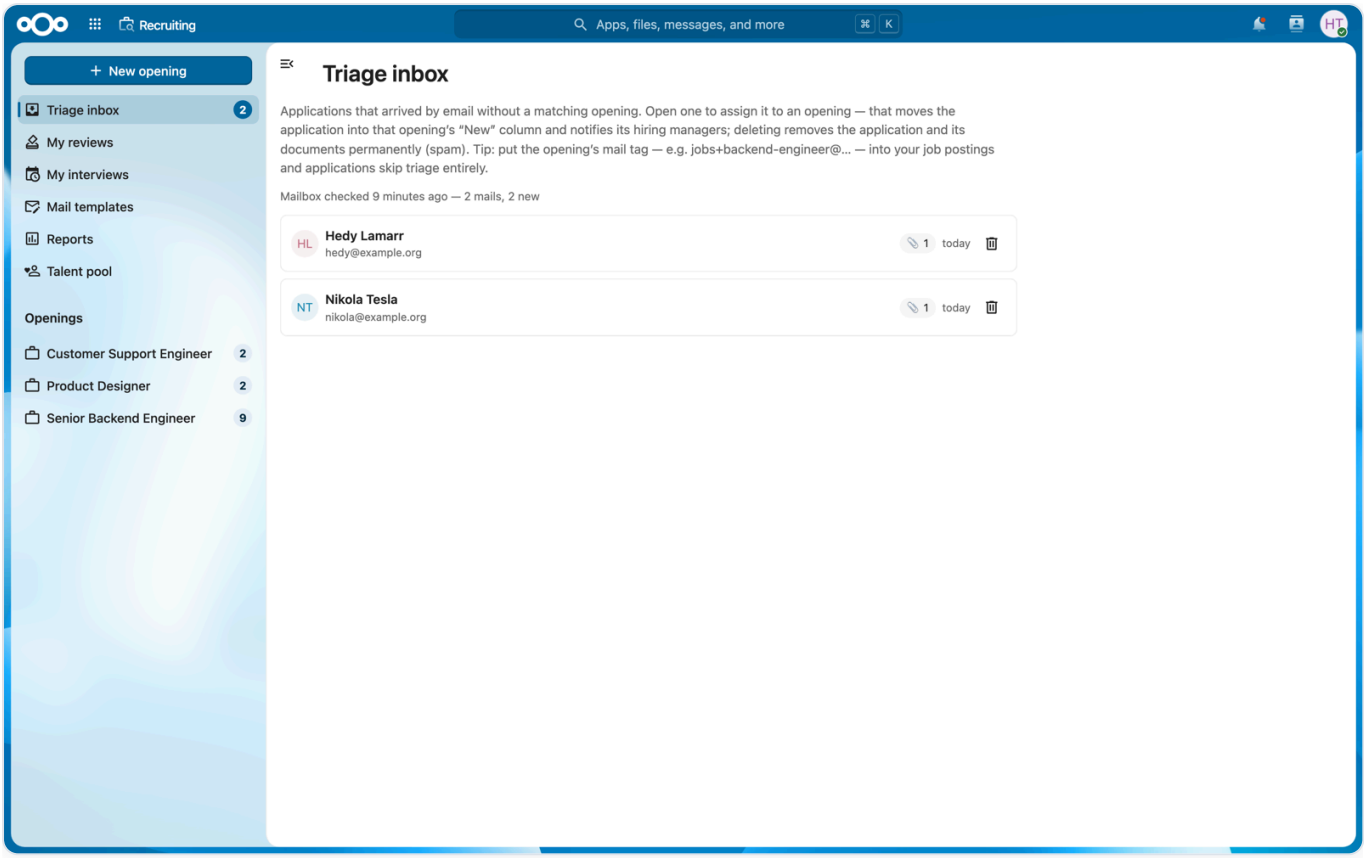
- Mails to `jobs+senior-backend-engineer@…` land **directly on that opening's board**, in the "New" column.
- The same works with `[senior-backend-engineer]` anywhere in the subject.
- Everything else goes to the **triage inbox**.

> 💡 Put the tagged address into your job postings — `jobs+product-designer@…` on the design job ad, and applications sort themselves. An automatic confirmation of receipt can be sent per opening, so applicants immediately know their documents arrived.

When candidates reply

Mails the app sends carry a personal reply address for each candidate. When Grace answers your interview invitation, her reply — attachments included — lands on *her* timeline and the hiring managers are notified. Replies never clutter the inbox as duplicate "applications".

The triage inbox



Unmatched applications wait here — assign them to an opening or delete spam.

Open a row and use **Assign to an opening** in the profile tab: the application moves into that opening's "New" column and its hiring managers are notified. Spam goes into the bin via the row's ⋮ menu — permanently, documents included.

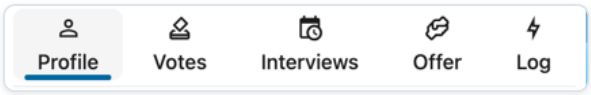
The heartbeat line `Mailbox checked 9 minutes ago — 2 mails, 2 new` shows when the mailbox was last checked. If a check fails, a warning appears here — so a broken mailbox can never silently swallow applications.

Adding candidates by hand

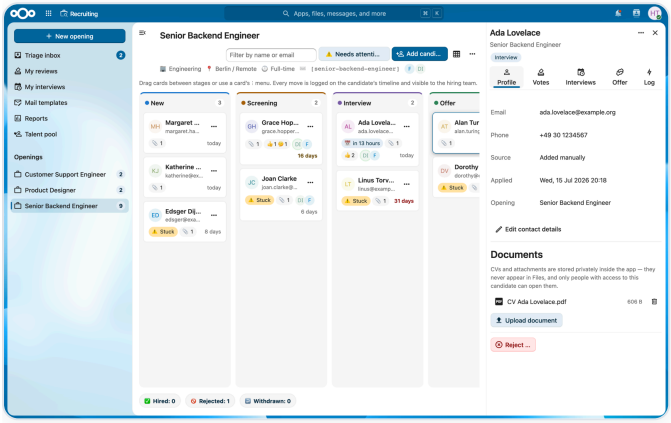
Somebody applied at a job fair or on paper? `+ Add candidate` on the opening's board opens a small form — name, contact details, drag the CV in, done. The candidate starts in "New" like everyone else.

04 The candidate file

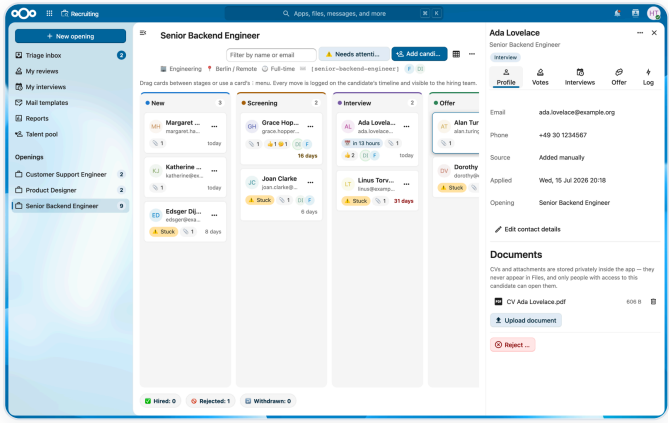
Click any card and the candidate file opens on the right — five tabs that hold everything about this person.



Profile



Contact details, source, application date — and the current stage at the top.



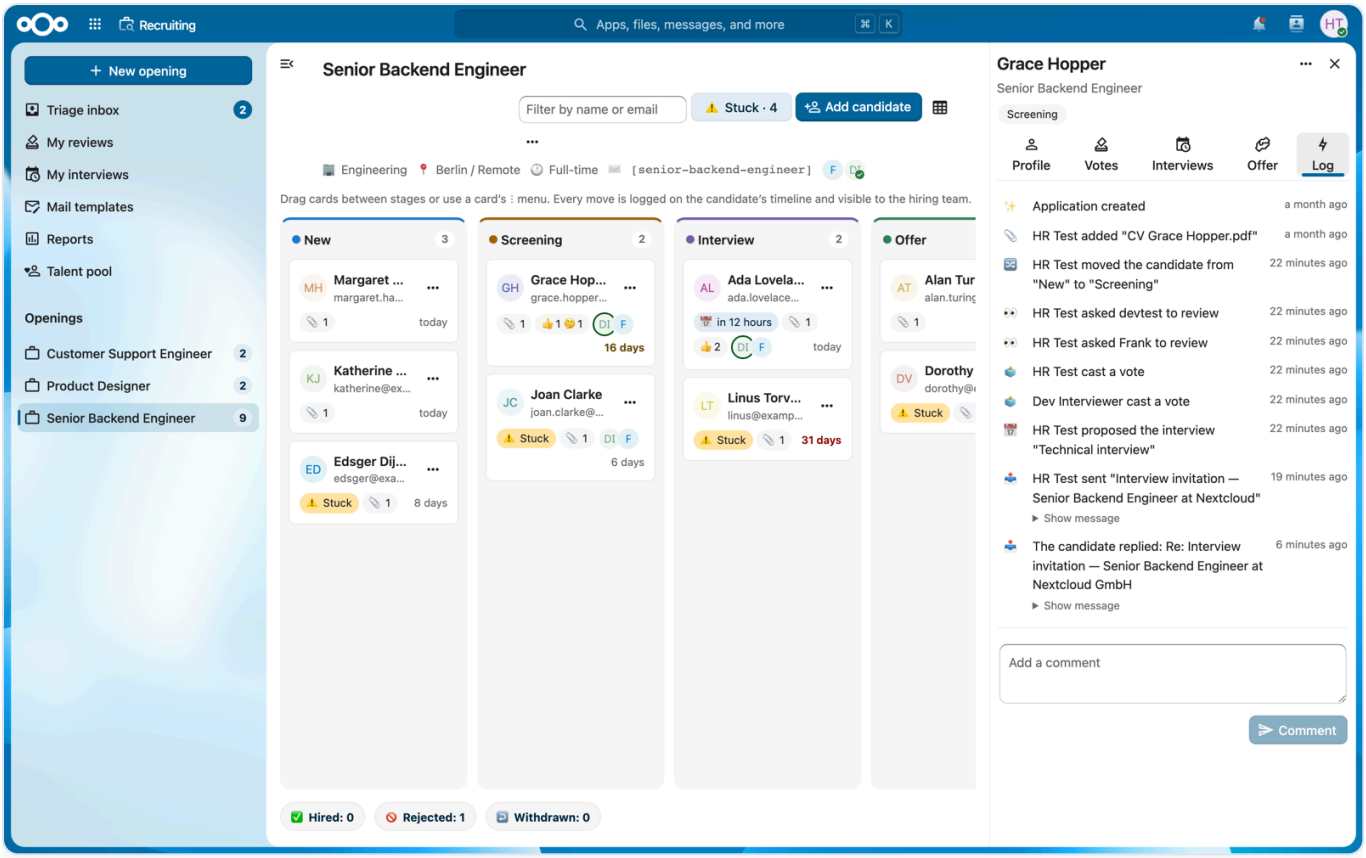
Documents live at the bottom of the profile: CVs open right in the browser.

- **Contact details** are editable by managers (Edit contact details).
- If the same address applied before, a **duplicate warning** links to the earlier application.
- With Nextcloud Assistant installed, an **AI summary** of the application can be generated — always labeled, never a decision.
- **Documents**: upload more, preview PDFs in the browser, delete. Stored privately in the app — never visible in Files.
- At the very bottom sits the red **Reject …** button — deliberately out of the way of everyday clicking (chapter 8).

The header menu (…)

Next to the candidate's name: **Book interview**, **Move to …** any stage, and for recruiters the GDPR actions — **Export data** (a ZIP with everything about this person, for data-access requests) and **Delete permanently**.

Log — the complete story



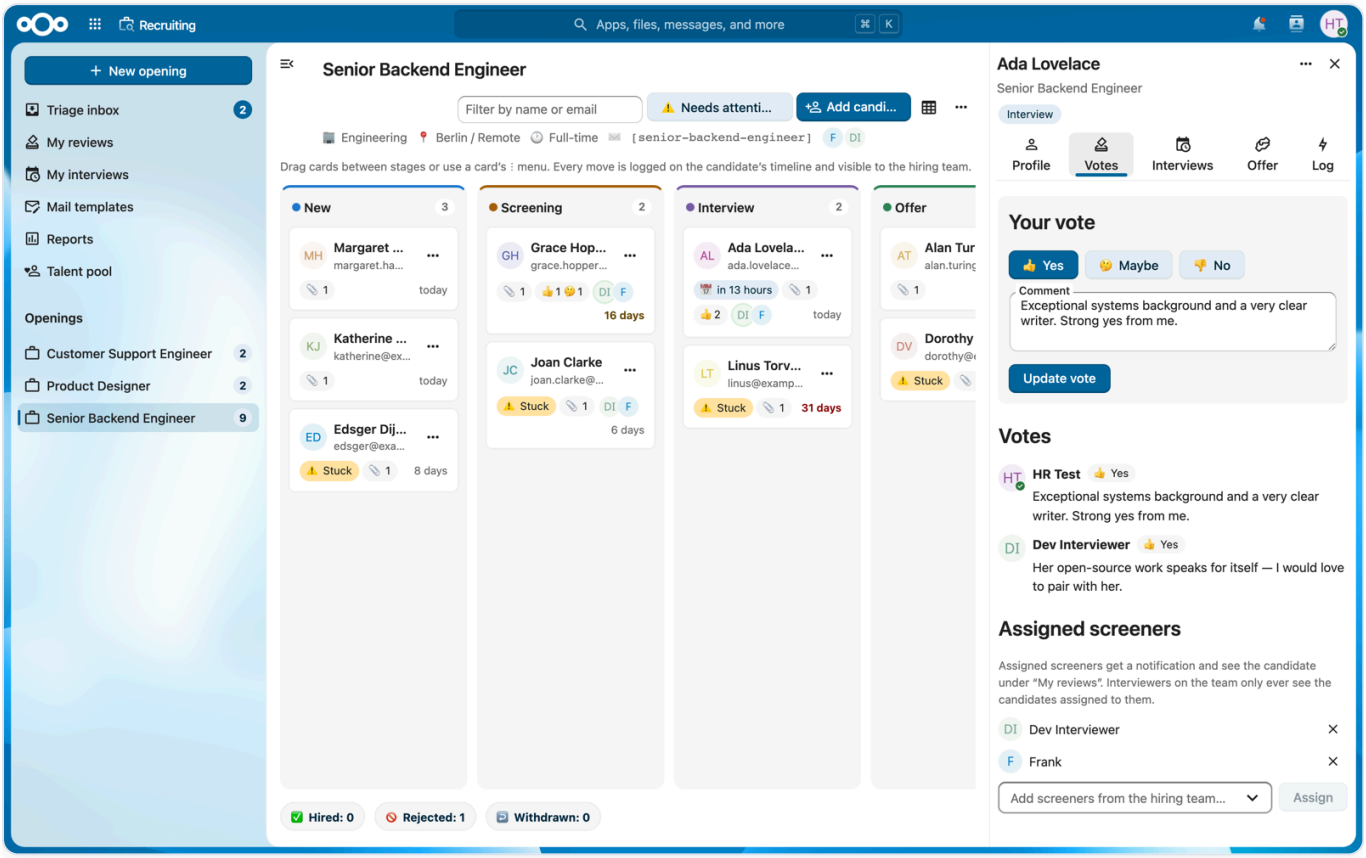
Every event in order — including the candidate's own reply ("The candidate replied…") — merged with the team discussion.

The Log tab is the timeline (stage moves, votes cast, every mail with its full text, interviews, offer steps) plus the **team discussion**. Write a comment and **@mention** a colleague to notify them — the conversation stays with the candidate instead of scattering across chats.

> The Votes, Interviews and Offer tabs each have their own chapter — read on.

05 Screening & votes

The Votes tab is designed for one thing: honest, independent opinions.



Your vote at the top, the votes of others below, assigned screeners at the bottom.

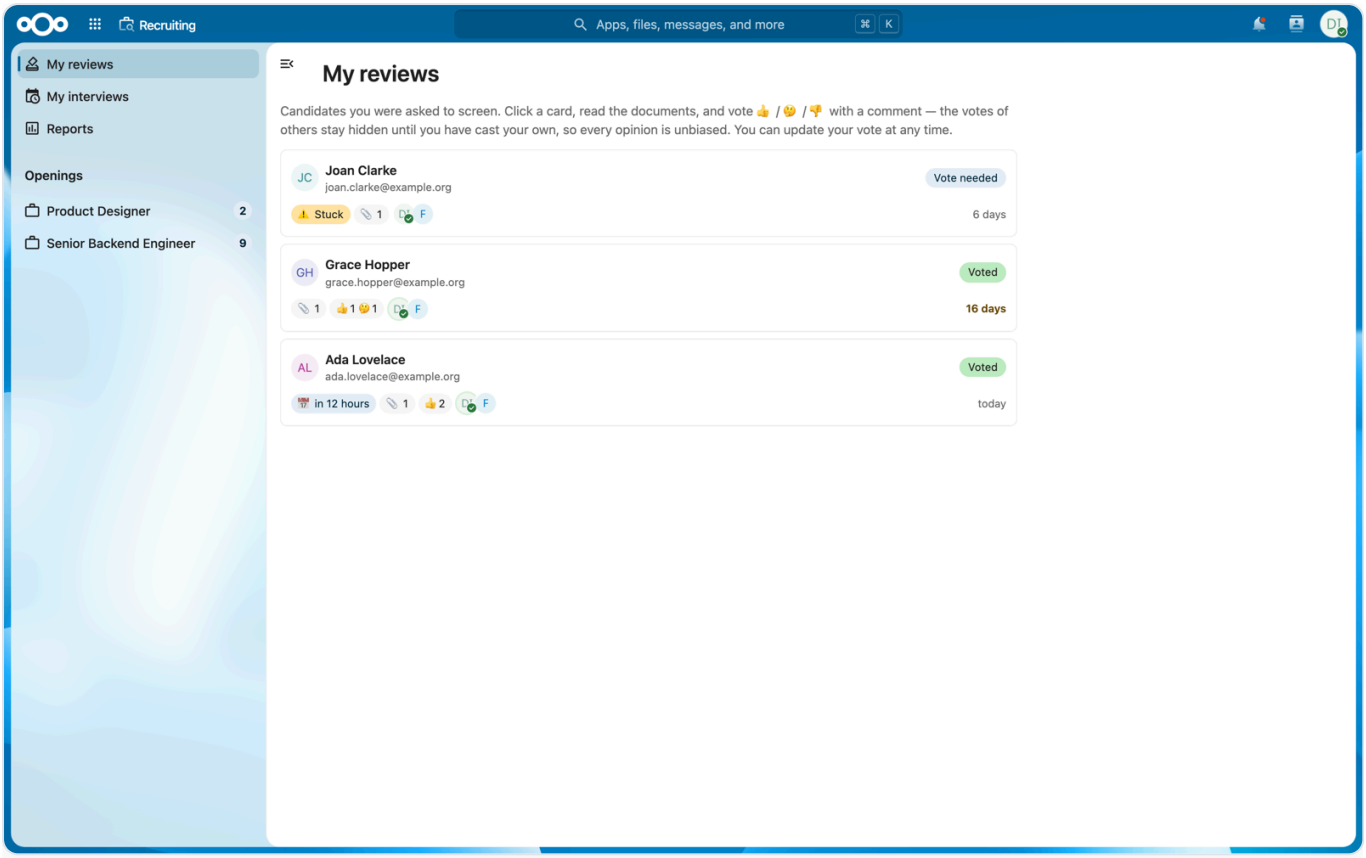
Casting your vote

Pick 👍 Yes 🤔 Maybe 👎 No and add a comment. A **"No" always needs a written reason** — "not a fit" is not a reason. You can update your vote at any time.

> 💡 **Why can't I see the other votes?** Because you haven't voted yet. Votes of others stay hidden until you cast your own, so your opinion is really *yours*. You can see *who* has voted (their names are listed) — just not what they said. This is by design and cannot be bypassed, not even via the timeline.

Assigning screeners

Managers add colleagues under **Assigned screeners**. Every assignee gets a notification and finds the candidate in **My reviews** — their personal to-do list, sorted by what still needs a vote:



"My reviews": what you still owe an opinion on. The badge in the navigation counts pending votes.

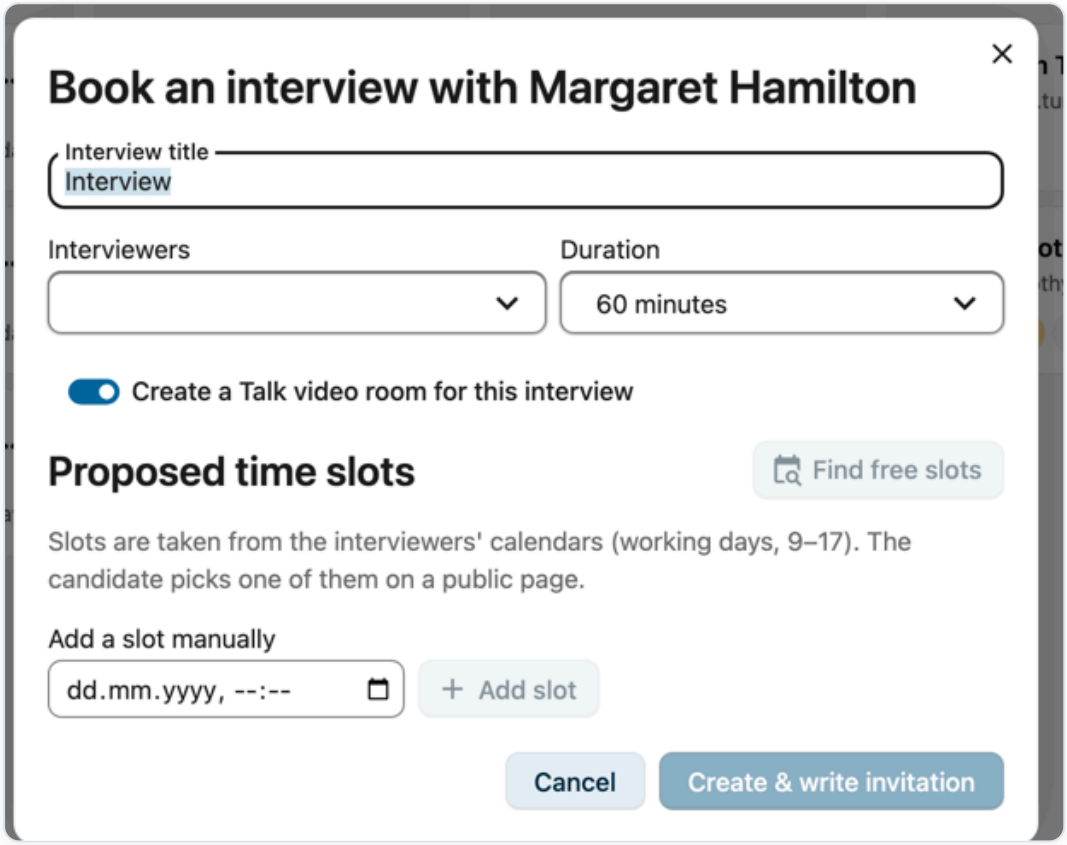
On the board you can follow the review round without opening a single card: the screener avatars on each card get a **green ring** as their vote comes in.

> With Assistant installed, an optional **AI screening hint** compares the application against the opening's requirements — labeled "verify yourself", because the humans decide.

06 Interviews

No email ping-pong about times: the app reads the interviewers' calendars, and the candidate picks a slot themselves.

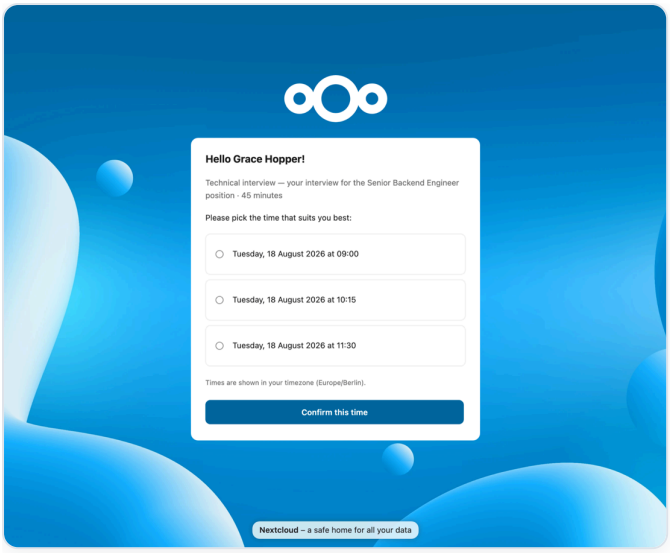
Booking an interview



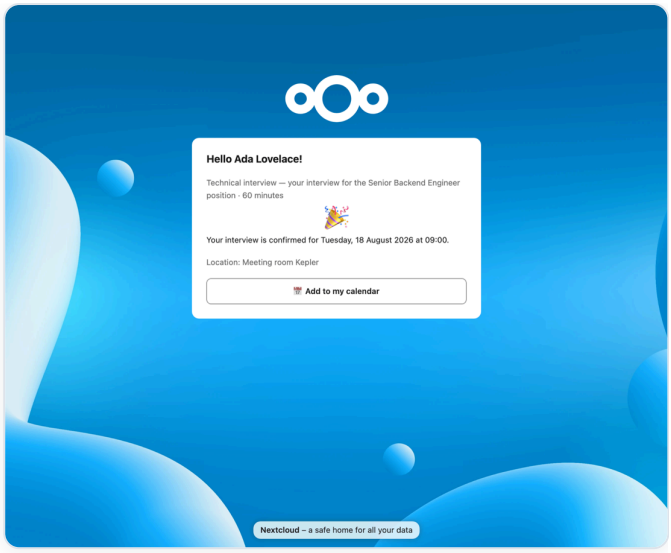
The booking dialog: interviewers, duration, Talk room — and proposed time slots.

1. Open the candidate → **Interviews** tab → **Book interview**. Give it a title ("Technical interview"), pick the interviewers and a duration.
2. Decide whether a **Talk video room** should be created (if Talk is installed). Switched off, you can note a meeting room — or paste a video link from another tool.
3. **Find free slots** looks into the interviewers' calendars (working days, 9–17) and proposes times. Untick any you dislike, add slots manually.
4. **Create & write invitation** shows the invitation mail — prefilled from your template, with the personal scheduling link. Edit freely and send. (If the link gets lost while editing, the app quietly re-attaches it.)

What the candidate sees



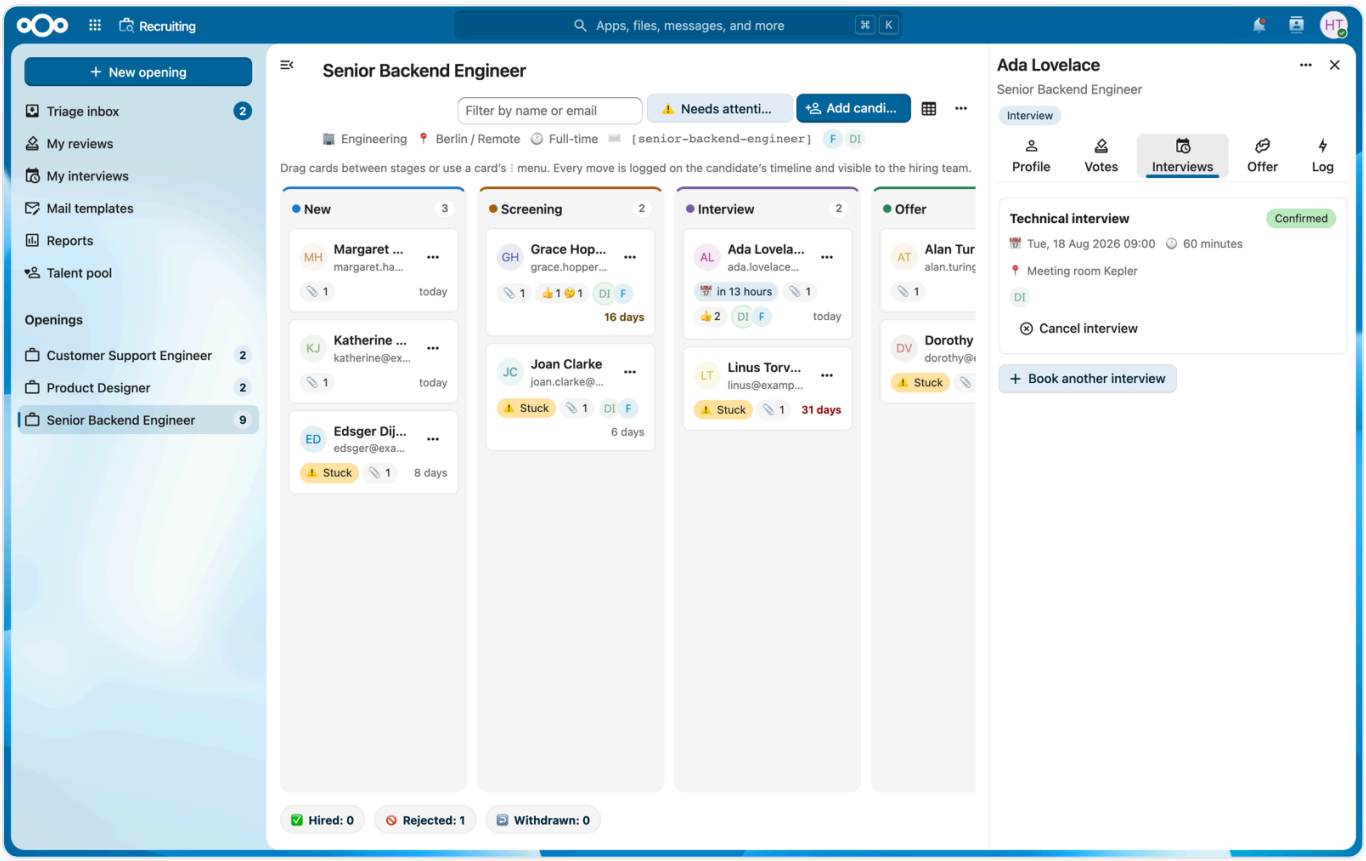
The scheduling page: no account, times in the *candidate*'s timezone.



After confirming: 🎉, the meeting details, and Add to my calendar for their own calendar.

The moment the candidate confirms a slot, everything happens at once: the calendar event lands in all interviewers' calendars, the Talk room is created (for video interviews), the card moves to **Interview**, and the panel is notified.

Keeping track



Every round with its status. "Awaiting candidate" = the link is out, no slot picked yet.

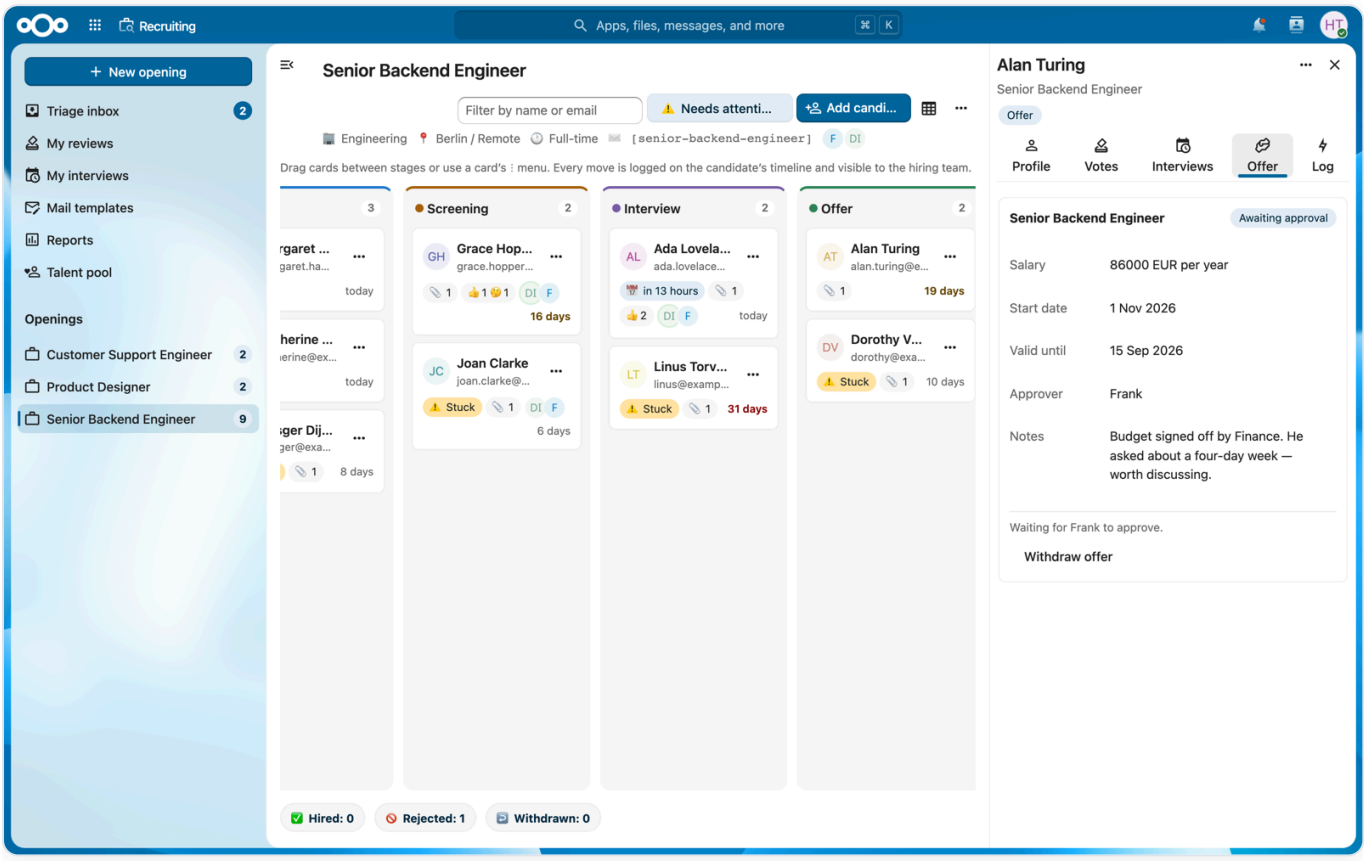
- **Copy scheduling link** — if you want to resend it yourself, or the candidate has no email address on file.

- **Cancel interview** — notifies all interviewers and removes the calendar event. The candidate page shows the cancellation.
- **My interviews** in the navigation lists your own panel appointments, including pending ones.

ℹ️ With Assistant installed, **Suggest interview questions** drafts questions grounded in the opening's requirements — pick what fits, ignore the rest.

07 Offers

Salary data is sensitive — so offers live behind an extra wall, and every offer needs a second pair of eyes before it can go out.



An offer awaiting approval. Only recruiters, this opening's managers and the chosen approver can see this tab at all.

The life of an offer

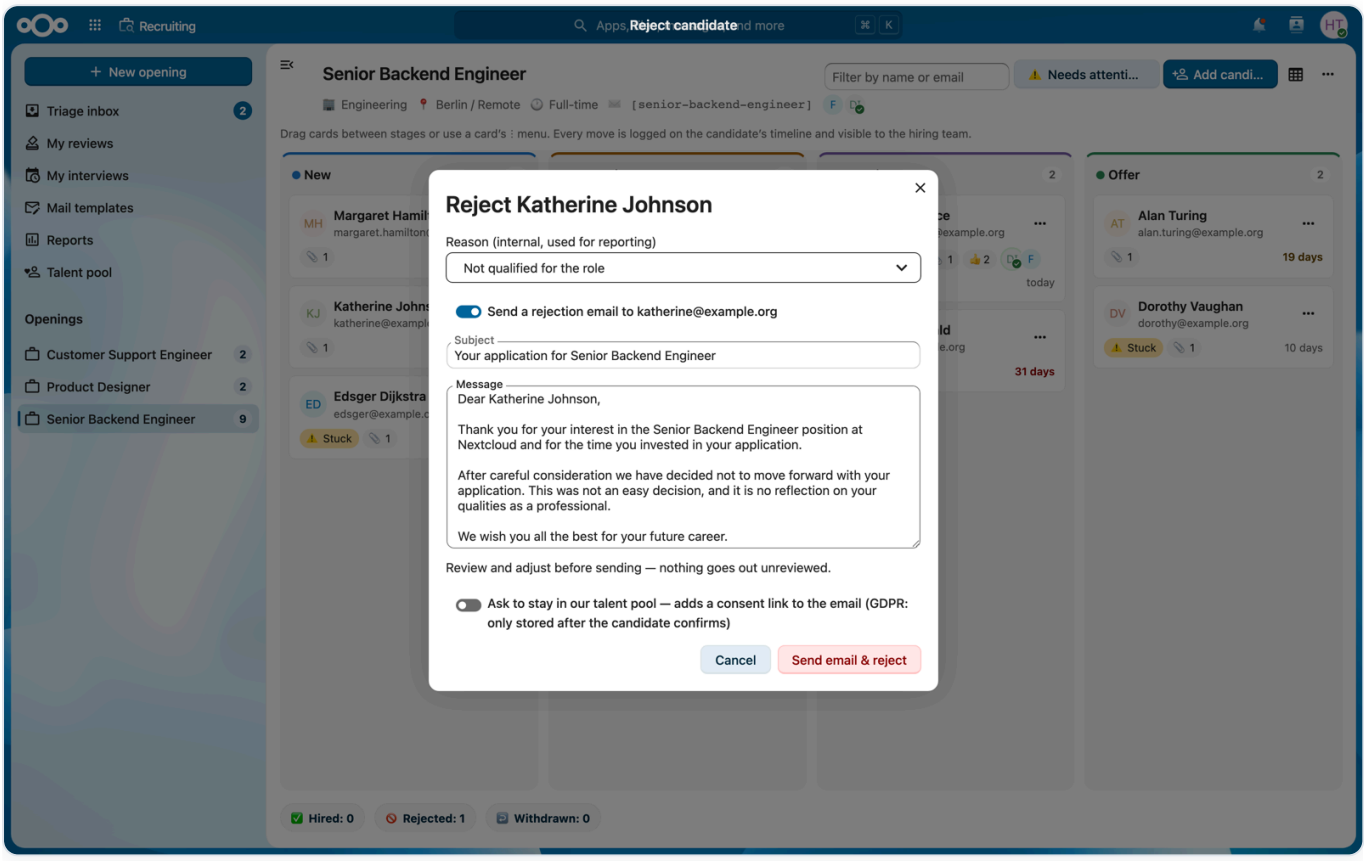
1. **Draft** the terms: job title, salary (amount, currency, per year/month/hour), start date, validity date, internal notes. Only drafts can be edited.
2. **Request approval** from a colleague. You can never pick yourself — four eyes are four eyes. The approver is notified, sees exactly this one candidate, and either approves or sends the offer back to draft with a note.
3. **Send the offer email** — with the usual preview — or use **Mark as sent** if the offer went out another way (phone, letter). Both start the validity clock. The card moves to the green Offer column.
4. **Record the answer**: *Accepted* moves the candidate to **Hired** 🎉 — remember to close the opening and tell the other candidates. *Declined* keeps them in the pipeline so you decide what happens next. *Negotiating* marks an ongoing conversation.

⚠️ Offers **expire automatically** after their validity date. The creator is warned three days ahead — and the board shows a ⚠️ Stuck chip on the candidate. An expired offer is final; draft a new one if the conversation continues.

🔒 Interviewers and observers never see offer terms — not in this tab (it is hidden for them), not on the timeline, not in the activity stream. Mails about offers show up for them only as "an email was sent".

08 Rejecting & the talent pool

Rejections decide your reputation as an employer. The app makes the respectful path the easy path.

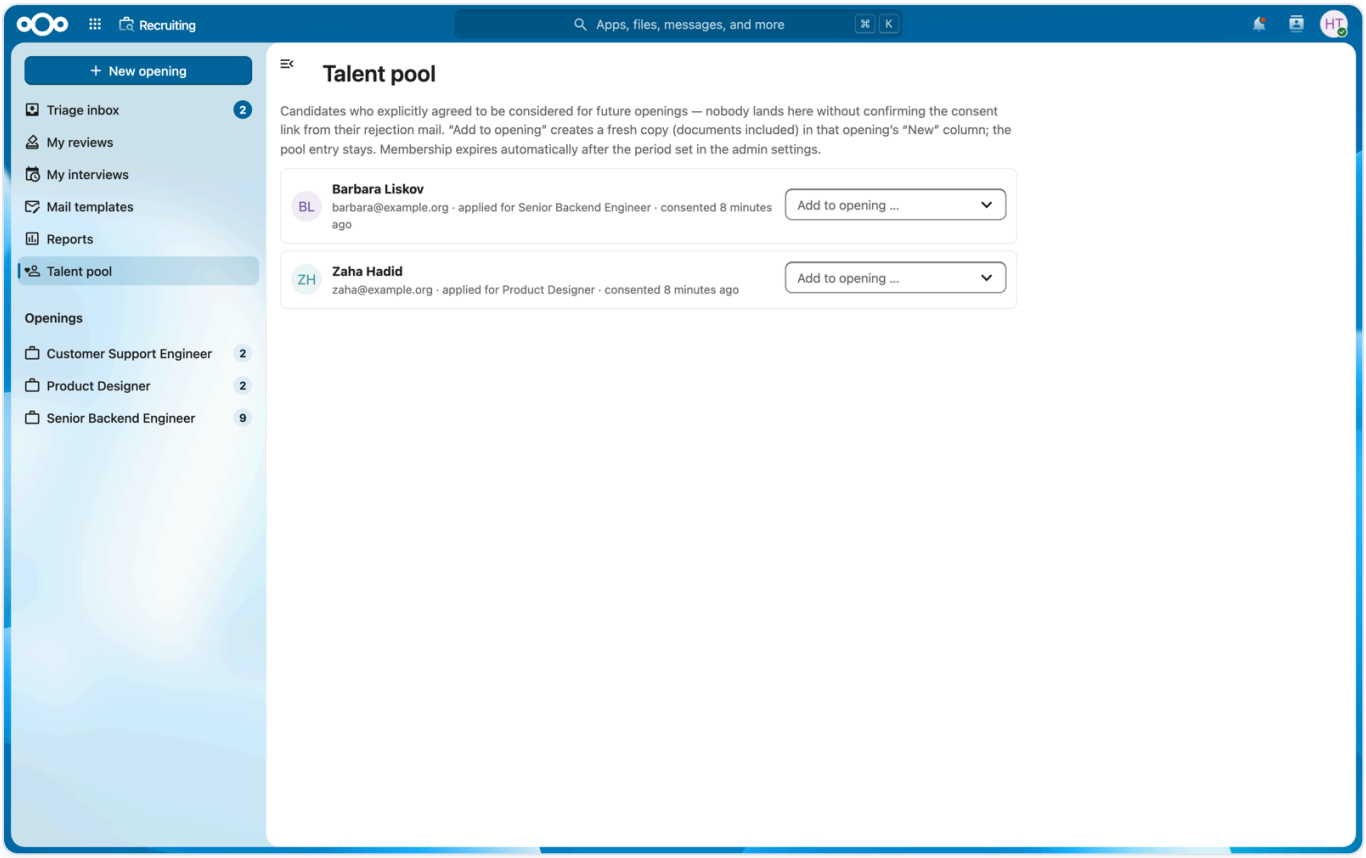


Reason, previewed mail, and the talent-pool invitation — all in one dialog.

The rejection flow

1. Click **Reject …** — the red button at the bottom of the profile tab, or in the card's ⋮ menu on the board.
2. Pick an **internal reason** (not qualified, better candidate chosen, position filled, withdrawn, other). Candidates never see it; your reports do.
3. Review the **rejection mail**, prefilled from your template. Edit every word if you like — or reject without an email (for candidates without an address, or when you called them personally).
4. Optionally tick **"Ask to stay in our talent pool"**.

The talent pool — strictly on consent



Only people who explicitly confirmed the consent link appear here.

The pool invitation adds a consent link to the rejection mail. Only when the candidate clicks it and confirms do they appear in the pool — nobody is kept "just in case" (that's not just polite, it's the GDPR). Pool membership expires automatically after the configured period.

When a fitting position opens later, **Add to opening** creates a fresh copy of the application — documents included — in that opening's "New" column. The pool entry stays until it expires or the person asks to be removed.

09 Staying on top of things

The app watches your pipeline so you don't have to.

The Stuck lens

Click ⚠ Stuck · 4 in the board header and only candidates where something is stuck remain. A candidate counts as stuck when:

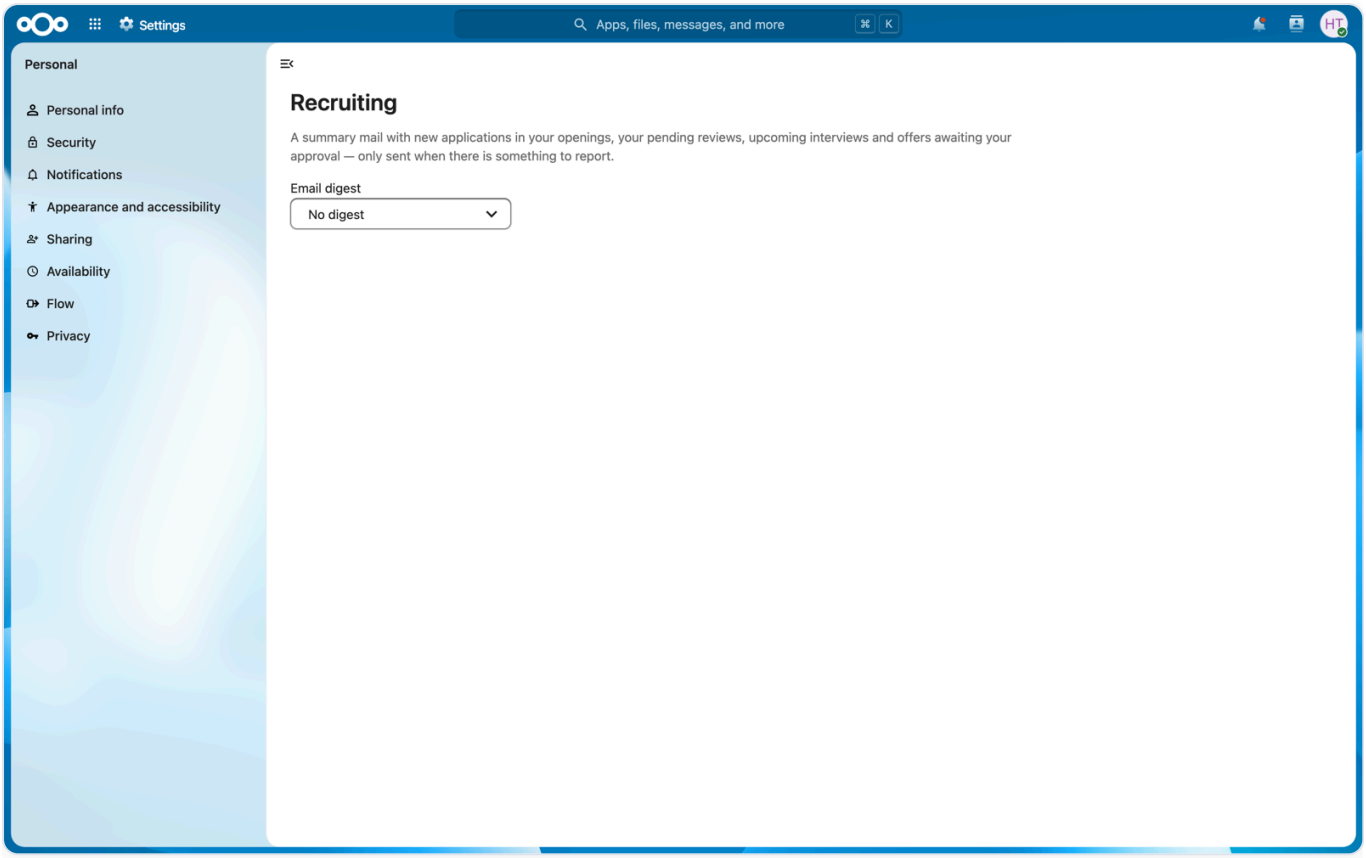
Situation	After
Waiting in New untouched	7 days
In Screening without a single vote	5 days
In Interview with no upcoming interview booked	3 days
In Offer without an active offer	3 days
A sent offer about to expire	3 days before expiry
Sitting in any stage	30 days

Each stuck card carries the ⚠ chip — hover it to read exactly what's missing. And independent of the chip, the time-in-stage on every card fades from gray to **amber (two weeks)** to **red (a month)**.

Notifications

You get a Nextcloud notification (bell, top right) when: a new application arrives in your opening · you are asked to review someone · you are added to an interview panel · a candidate confirms or a candidate replies · an offer waits for your approval · an offer is about to expire · someone @mentions you.

The email digest



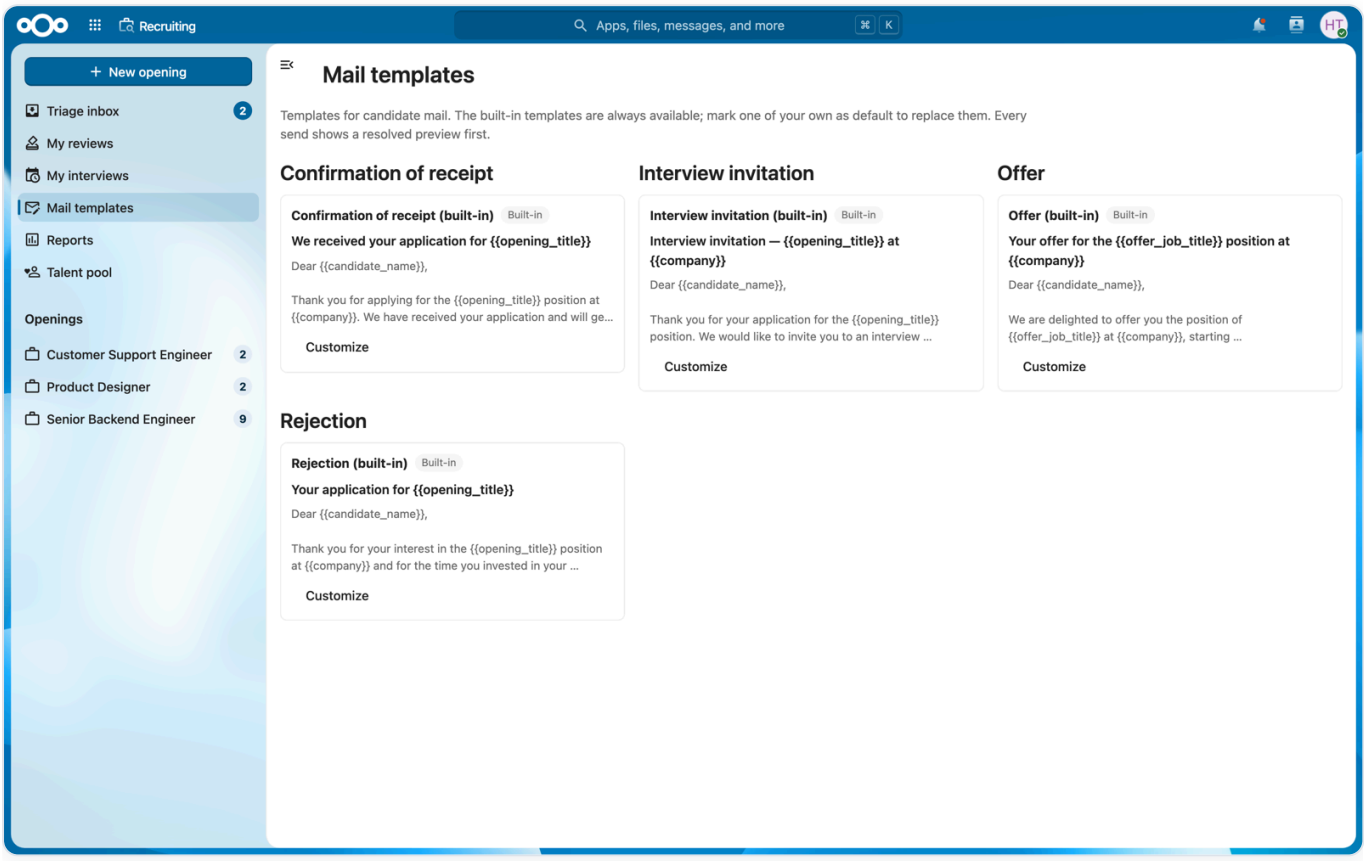
Personal settings → Groupware: a daily or weekly recruiting summary by mail.

Prefer email? Enable the digest — new applications in your openings, pending reviews, upcoming interviews and offers awaiting your approval, in one mail. It is only sent when there is actually something to report.

> 💡 Recruiting results also show up in Nextcloud's universal search (`Ctrl` + `K` / `⌘` + `K`) — type a candidate's name from anywhere in Nextcloud.

10 Mail templates

Four mail types — confirmation of receipt, interview invitation, rejection, offer — each with a built-in template you can replace with your own voice.



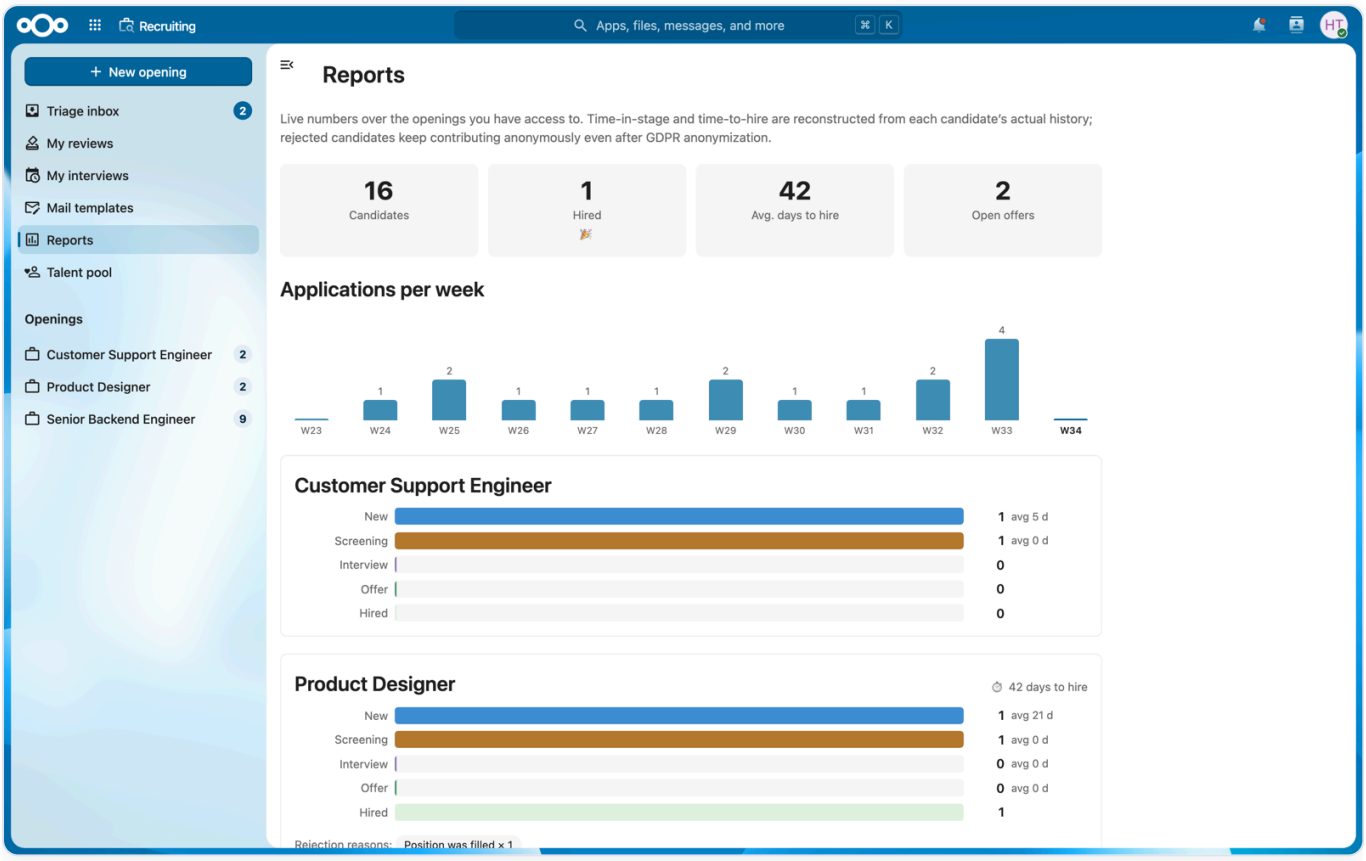
One column per mail type. **Customize** copies a built-in template into an editable one; **Make default** activates it.

In the editor, **placeholders** like `{{candidate_name}}` or `{{interview_link}}` appear as chips — click one to insert it at the cursor. Each mail type only offers the placeholders it can actually fill, and templates are validated when you save: a typo in a placeholder can never reach a candidate.

> Templates are the *starting point*, not the final word: every send shows the resolved text first, and you can edit it per candidate.

11 Reports

Honest numbers, reconstructed from what actually happened — you only see openings you have access to.



Headline numbers, applications per week, and per opening the funnel in stage colors.

- **Headline tiles**: total candidates (with this week's trend), hired, average days to hire, open offers.
- **Applications per week** — the last twelve weeks, current week highlighted.
- **Per opening**: the funnel (how many candidates sit in each stage, in the stage colors you know from the board), the average time spent in each stage, days-to-hire, open offers, and the breakdown of rejection reasons.

🔒 Numbers survive anonymization: when a rejected candidate's personal data is automatically erased after the retention period, their anonymous journey still counts in the funnel and averages. Your statistics stay honest without keeping personal data.

12 Privacy & GDPR

Everything stays on your own server, and the compliance chores run on autopilot.

Where candidate data lives

- All data is stored in your Nextcloud — nothing is ever sent to a third party.
- Documents live in protected app storage: they never appear in the Files app, and only people with access to that candidate can open them.
- Access follows the roles from chapter 1 — interviewers only see their assigned candidates and never any salary data.

Automatic retention

Rejected and withdrawn candidates are **anonymized automatically** after the retention period your admin configures (typically a few months). Name, contact data, documents, mail texts, comments and summaries are erased; the anonymous stage history stays for the reports. Expired talent-pool memberships are anonymized the same way.

When a candidate asks…

Request	What you do
"What data do you have about me?"	Candidate header menu → **Export data (GDPR)**. You get a ZIP with their profile, correspondence, interviews, offer terms and documents. Reviewer names and internal team comments are *not* included — those are your colleagues' personal data.
"Please delete my data."	Candidate header menu → **Delete permanently (GDPR)**. Removes the candidate with all documents, votes, comments, interviews and notifications. Irreversible, with a confirmation dialog.
"Keep me in mind for later."	That's the talent pool — and it only happens after the candidate confirms the consent link themselves (chapter 8).

For your admin

The administration settings (Administration → Recruiting) hold the technical setup: the application mailbox (IMAP), the HR group, the sender identity, the retention period and the talent-pool duration. Admins configure — they don't see candidates.

> 💡 Questions this handbook doesn't answer? Ask your recruiting team, or open the candidate's Log tab — chances are the answer is already in the history. Happy hiring! 🎉